血里的指纹

The Fingerprint in the Blood



DNA为何先替无辜者洗清嫌疑?

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In November 1983 a 15-year-old girl was murdered in the Leicestershire village of Narborough, and the homicide went unsolved. In the summer of 1986 a second 15-year-old was slain near neighbouring Enderby. A 17-year-old local youth confessed to the second killing, and to detectives the perplexing investigation was seemingly resolved.

The revelation had come two years previously. On 10 September 1984 Alec Jeffreys, a geneticist at the University of Leicester, discerned on an X-ray film molecular markers whose layout varied considerably from person to person. He called them DNA fingerprints, since, like fingerprints, they differentiated individuals. The journal Nature promptly carried his paper in March 1985.

Police enlisted Jeffreys, and his genetic tests overturned the erroneous confession. The youth was not the perpetrator, and the same attacker had killed both girls. The youth became the first person known to be cleared by DNA evidence. The forensic innovation had freed an innocent before it implicated anyone.

In January 1987 police commenced the world's first large-scale DNA screening, asking more than 5,000 men in three villages for blood or saliva. None matched. The elusive killer, a local baker, had induced a co-worker to give a sample in his name, evading suspicion. In August 1987 someone overheard the co-worker discussing the substitution and notified police.

Colin Pitchfork was detained on 19 September 1987, and his DNA profile matched. In January 1988 he pleaded guilty and was jailed for life, the first person convicted of murder on the basis of DNA evidence. A tip-off, not the screening, had unmasked him. The test's first beneficiary had been a blameless juvenile who had falsely admitted the offence.

中文译文

1983年11月，一名15岁女孩在莱斯特郡的纳伯勒村遇害，这起凶杀案一直没有侦破。1986年夏天，又一名15岁女孩在邻近的恩德比附近被杀。一名17岁的当地少年供认了第二起命案；在警探们看来，这场令人困惑的调查似乎终于有了结果。

那项关键发现，其实早在两年前就已经出现。1984年9月10日，莱斯特大学遗传学家亚历克·杰弗里斯在一张X光胶片上辨认出一些分子标记，它们的排列在人与人之间差别很大。他把这些标记称为DNA指纹，因为它们和指纹一样，可以区分不同的人。《自然》期刊很快就在1985年3月刊登了他的论文。

警方请来杰弗里斯协助调查，他的基因检测推翻了那份错误供词。那名少年并非行凶者，而两名女孩确实是被同一个人杀害的。少年成为已知第一位凭DNA证据洗清嫌疑的人。在凭这项技术指认任何人涉案之前，这项法医学创新先让一名无辜者重获自由。

1987年1月，警方开始了世界上第一次大规模DNA筛查，请三个村庄的5000多名男子提供血液或唾液样本，结果没有一份吻合。那名难以追查的凶手是一位当地面包师；他事先诱使同事冒用自己的姓名提供样本，从而躲过怀疑。1987年8月，有人无意中听见这名同事谈论冒名顶替的事，便通知了警方。

1987年9月19日，科林·皮奇福克被拘留，他的DNA图谱与案件中的样本吻合。1988年1月，他认罪并被判终身监禁，成为第一位依据DNA证据被判谋杀罪的人。揭开他真面目的，是一条举报线索，而不是那次筛查本身。这项检测最先帮助的，却是一名清白的少年——他曾错误地承认自己犯下了那起罪行。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

homicide n.
凶杀；杀人案件
and the homicide went unsolved.

confess v.
供认；坦白
confessed to the second killing

investigation n.
调查；侦查
the perplexing investigation

geneticist n.
遗传学家
a geneticist

discern v.
辨认出；察觉
discerned on an X-ray film

molecular adj.
分子的
molecular markers

vary v.
存在差异；变化
layout varied considerably

differentiate v.
区分
they differentiated individuals.

overturn v.
推翻（原有判断或供词）
overturned the erroneous confession.

erroneous adj.
错误的
the erroneous confession.

perpetrator n.
作案者；行凶者
The youth was not the perpetrator,

forensic adj.
法医学的；刑事鉴证的
The forensic innovation

innovation n.
创新；新技术
The forensic innovation

innocent n.
无辜者
had freed an innocent

implicate v.
牵连；表明……涉案
before it implicated anyone.

commence v.
开始
In January 1987 police commenced

elusive adj.
难以找到或抓住的
The elusive killer, a local baker,

induce v.
诱使；促使
had induced a co-worker

substitution n.
替代；此处指冒名顶替
discussing the substitution

profile n.
此处指DNA图谱
his DNA profile matched.

tip-off n.
举报线索
A tip-off, not the screening,

beneficiary n.
受益者
The test's first beneficiary

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共32项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

unsolved adj.
未侦破的

slay v.
杀死（过去分词）

neighbouring adj.
邻近的

detective n.
警探；侦查人员

perplexing adj.
令人困惑的

seemingly adv.
看上去；似乎

resolve v.
解决

revelation n.
重要的新发现

previously adv.
先前；以前

marker n.
标记

layout n.
排列方式；布局

considerably adv.
相当地；很大程度上

promptly adv.
迅速地；及时地

enlist v.
请……协助

genetic adj.
基因的；遗传的

confession n.
供词；认罪陈述

attacker n.
袭击者

large-scale adj.
大规模的

saliva n.
唾液

co-worker n.
同事

evade v.
避开；躲过

suspicion n.
怀疑

overhear v.
无意中听见

notify v.
通知

detain v.
拘留

plead v.
作答辩；此处指认罪

jail v.
监禁

unmask v.
揭穿；揭露真面目

blameless adj.
无辜的；无可指责的

juvenile n.
未成年人；少年

falsely adv.
错误地；不实地

offence n.
罪行

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Police enlisted Jeffreys, and his genetic tests _____ the erroneous confession.

02 The youth was not the _____, and the same attacker had killed both girls.

03 In August 1987 someone overheard the co-worker discussing the _____ and notified police.

04 The test's first _____ had been a blameless juvenile who had falsely admitted the offence.

文章主线

- 发现 杰弗里斯发现DNA标记的排列因人而异，可像指纹一样辨认身份，由此提出DNA指纹。
- 洗冤 两名少女遇害后，一名少年供认第二起命案；DNA检验却证明他无辜，并确认两案出自同一凶手。
- 筛查 警方对五千多名男子开展世界首次大规模DNA筛查，却无一吻合；真凶让同事冒名采样，因而漏网。
- 破案 有人听见同事谈及顶替而举报；警方循线找到皮奇福克，DNA检验确认他是真凶。
- 结局 少年成为已知首位凭DNA证据获洗冤者；皮奇福克随后认罪、被判终身监禁，成为首位凭DNA证据被判谋杀罪者。

参考答案　1 overturned 2 perpetrator 3 substitution 4 beneficiary